much more than that. Brown secured the confidence of the son of the Raja of Nagar Haveli, Raja Muzaffar-ul-Din Shah. The two of them developed a close friendship which was founded upon a common strategic agenda: to deny, at any cost, the accession of the Gilgit Agency and the vassal states to India. Brown also developed close ties with the ruler of Chitral, the Mir of Hunza, the Raja of Yasin and the Raja of Puniyal. Unfortunately for Maharaja Hari Singh, he remained blissfully unaware of the alliances Brown was forming in the northern tracts of his own state.

One wonders why Brown was posted to the Gilgit region in 1943, in the first place. What were his orders and who was he reporting to? What was the chain of command in the mission he was serving? Was he ordered to secure the complete confidence of the Raja's of the Gilgit Agency and the vassal states, and what was all this groundwork serving? What was the endgame in sight for the British, and what do the British archives reveal about this issue, today?




**Image 2.5:** Map of all the vassal states of the Maharaja of Kashmir
*Source: Archives of AIM Television Pvt. Ltd.*